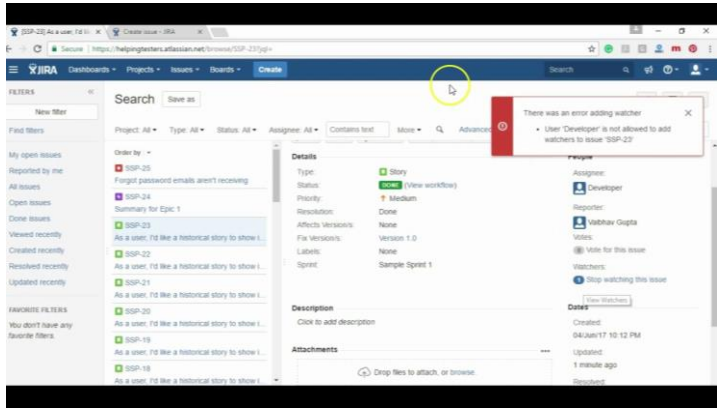
LESSON 8

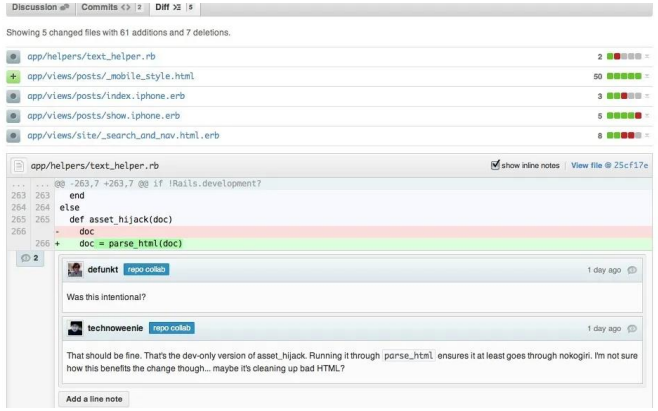
Lesson 8: Written Communication

Slack, Email, Jira, and PR Comment English

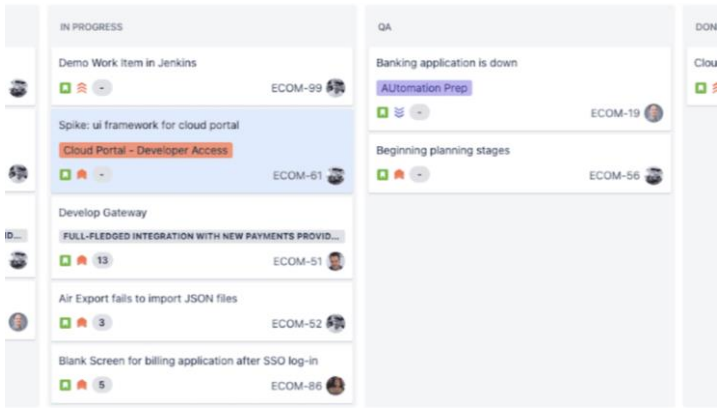
远程工程团队常见书面协作场景英文表达



Ticketing & Issues



Code Review & PR Comments



Kanban Board & Workflow

Session Focus

Write updates, blockers, clarification messages, handoffs, and review comments clearly.

Written communication is part of engineering execution — not just language practice.

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Why Written Communication Matters

工作英语写作 = 远程协作效率

1. Execution

Writing is part of execution, not just language.

2. Remote work

Remote teams collaborate through Slack, Jira, email, and PR comments.

3. Quality

Good messages are clear, brief, contextual, and actionable.

4. Outcome

Report status, explain blockers, ask for help, and hand off work.

Key idea

★ Clear writing builds trust and keeps work moving.

★ 重点：说清楚当前状态、阻塞点和下一步。

Good written communication reduces confusion and unnecessary follow-up.

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Different Tools, Different Tone

Slack / Email / Jira / PR Comment 的区别

Tool	Purpose	Tone
Slack / Chat	Quick updates, short questions, lightweight follow-up	Short, direct, friendly
Email	Cross-team summaries, approvals, formal follow-up	Structured and formal
Jira / Tickets	Work tracking, status visibility, traceable updates	Specific and factual
PR Comments	Code review, risk notes, implementation discussion	Constructive and collaborative

Rule

- The same information should be written differently depending on the tool.
- 工具不同，tone 也要不同。

Before writing, ask: where am I writing, and what does the reader need to do next?

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What Makes a Good Work Message

信息清楚，工作才好推进

What is the issue or update?

What is the current status?

Is there a blocker?

Do you need anything from the other person?

What is the next step?

Weak version

I'm checking it.

Better version

I'm looking into the API latency issue now. I've checked the latest deployment logs, and next I'm going to compare the most recent config changes.

Useful formula

- Context + Progress + Next Step
- 中文提示：一句更新最好有"背景、进展、下一步"。

A useful message helps the next person understand what to do next.

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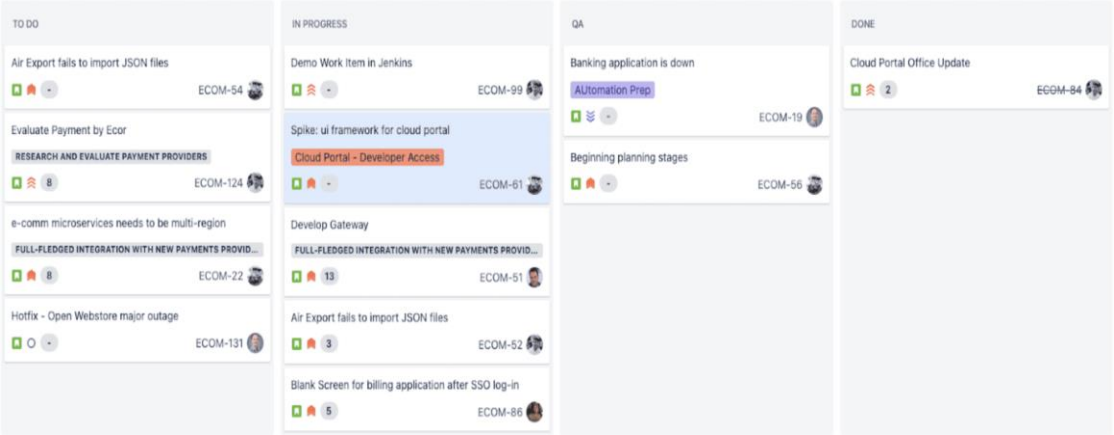
Four Common Writing Scenarios

远程工程团队最常见的四类文字沟通

These four categories cover most daily written communication.

练熟这四类：status / blocker / clarification / handoff。



1. Status update

I’ve completed the initial review of the deployment workflow, and I’m now checking the related staging configuration.

2. Blocker

I’m currently blocked because I still don’t have access to the production monitoring dashboard.

3. Clarification

Just to confirm, should I prioritize the API issue first, or is the dashboard bug more urgent?

4. Handoff / Follow-up

I’ve added my findings to the ticket and completed my part. Please continue from the monitoring side when you’re online.

Writing is how remote teams keep work moving when people are not online at the same time.

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Writing Useful Jira Updates

Jira / Ticket update 怎么写得清楚

what has been done

what is still pending

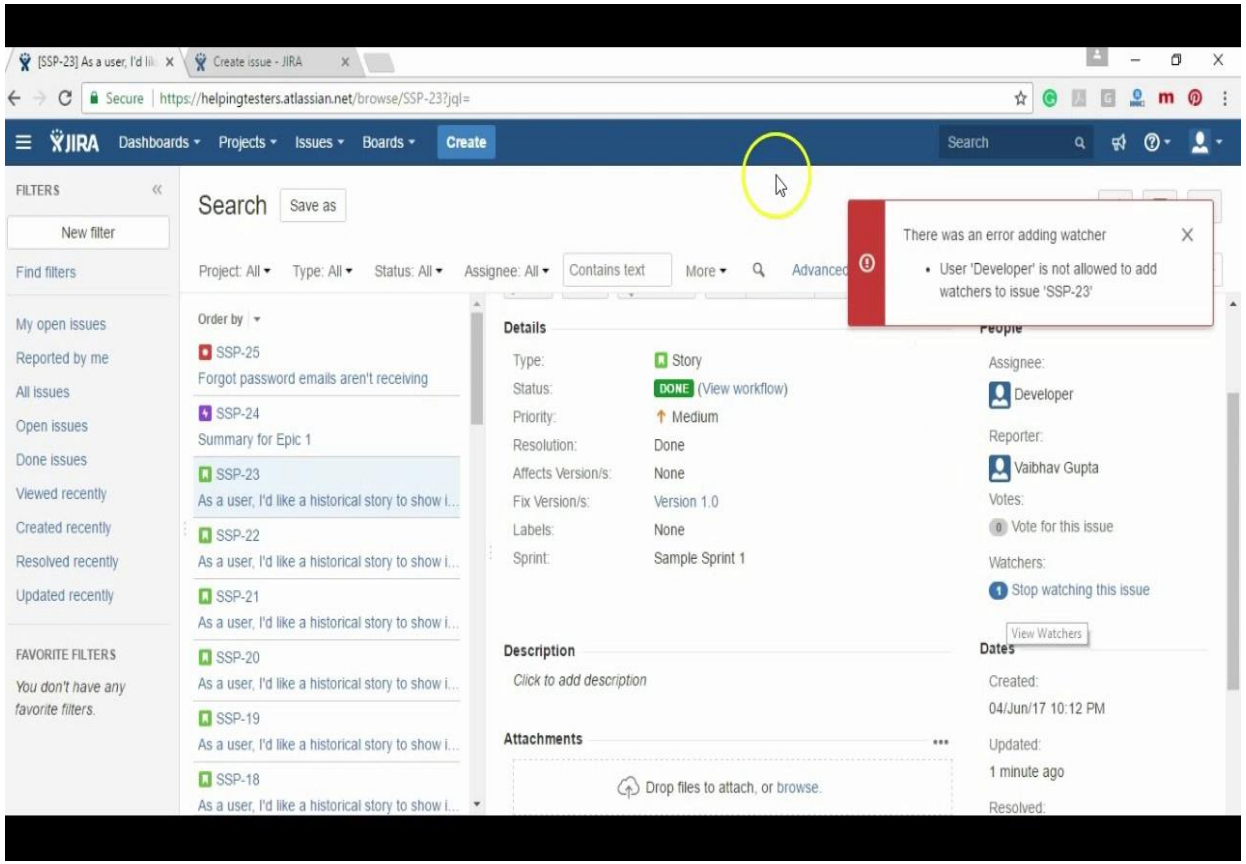
what is blocked

what the dependency is

what the next action is

Sample Jira update

- I’ve started working on this ticket and completed the initial log review.
- The remaining work depends on access to the staging environment.
- Once that access is available, I’ll continue with validation.



Ticket updates should make status visible and traceable. 工单更新要有“状态感”。

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Writing Better PR Comments

Clear, Constructive, Collaborative / 代码评审中的英文表达

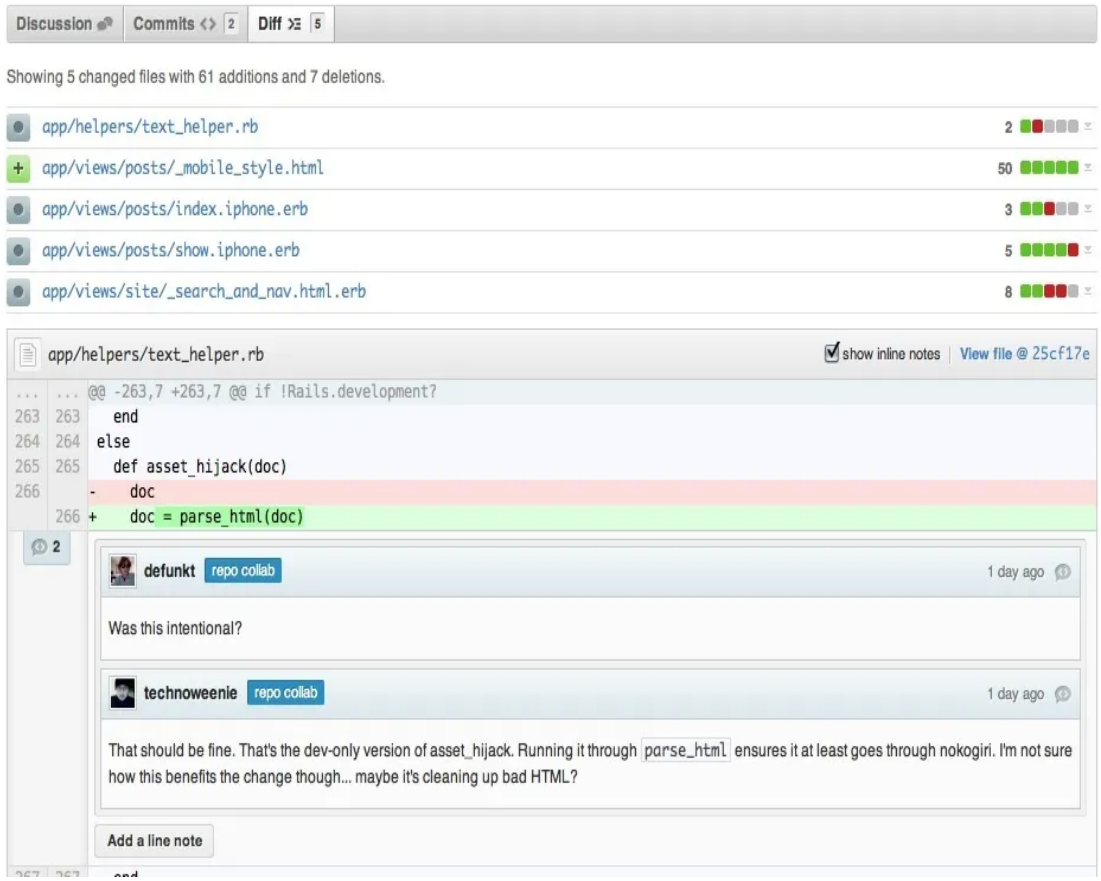
PR comments should improve code, not attack people.

Useful moves: explain, suggest, ask, highlight risk, and confirm.

Good tone makes collaboration smoother.

Useful review phrases

- ✓ It might be worth extracting this into a helper function.
- ✓ Just to clarify, should this also handle timeout-related failures?
- ✓ One thing to watch out for is repeated cache misses.
- ✓ This looks good to me — thanks for adding the extra validation.



The goal is to sound collaborative, not aggressive.

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Phrase Bank & Final Takeaways

Status / Blocker

- I've started working on this.
- I'm currently blocked by...
- The main blocker is...
- I'll post another update once...

Clarification / Follow-up

- Just to confirm, should I...?
- Could you provide more context on...?
- I wanted to follow up on...
- Let me know if you need more context.

PR Comment Tone

- It might be worth...
- One thing to watch out for is...
- Would it make sense to...?
- This looks good to me.

Three rules

✓ Clear is better than advanced.

✓ Context makes your message useful.

✓ Every update should help the next person move forward.

Clear writing builds trust in remote teams. 写清楚的人更容易让团队信任。